

TCD Template

Day 1 handout. The 6-section Technical Concept Document (TCD) skeleton your triad builds across Week 4 — the sibling artifact to your Week-3 PRD. Print it, pin it, fill it section by section. Each section carries a [Day X] tag telling you when it gets written. Friday it ships, peer-reviewed and signed off.

Technical Concept Document – <feature name>

Sibling to: PRD <link> | **Authors:** <triad> | **Status:**
Draft / Reviewed

1. Architecture stance [Day 1]

Monolith / microservice / hybrid. One paragraph defending the call from business + operational angles (deploy cadence, failure domain, scaling axis) –
not framework hype.

2. Integration map [Day 1 + Day 3]

Which existing systems / services this feature depends on, calls, or extends.
Drafted Day 1 as the 5-column table (system / owner / sync-async / R-W /
failure handling); references the C4 Container diagram drawn on Day 3.

3. Security & compliance constraints [Day 2]

STRIDE pass summary – the 3–5 highest-priority threats and their concrete mitigations. Updated security and compliance NFRs (replaces the Week-3 first draft). Name which compliance frame applies (SOC 2 / privacy / industry).

4. SLO + rate-limit policy [Day 4]

- Latency: p50 / p95 / p99 targets, each with a one-line defense
- Availability: monthly target + error budget
- Rate limits: per-user / per-tenant / global, and what each protects

5. Top 5 trade-offs [Day 5]

Each trade-off names: Option A, Option B, the call we made, the cost we accept,
and the trigger that would cause us to revisit. Span at least 3 categories.

6. Stakeholders + sign-off matrix [Day 5]

| Constraint (TCD section) | Stakeholder (a person) | Status | Next step |

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Status vocabulary: Proposed / Discussed / Approved / Blocked.

How the sections build on each other

- **§1 stance** sets the shape everything else documents. A modular-monolith stance shows in §2 as one container with internal modules.
- **§2 integrations** are the boundaries §3 threat-models — every integration either appears in the threat model or has an explicit "no threat" rationale.
- **§3 security NFRs** must not silently conflict with **§4 SLOs**; if they do, that tension is a **§5 trade-off**.
- **§5 trade-offs** and **§6 owners** are what a senior architect interrogates first — every load-bearing decision has an owner in §6.

Friday review rubric (score 0–4 per dimension)

Dimension	Weight	Exemplary
Stance defensibility	20%	Architecture call defended in business terms; framework hype absent
Threat-model rigor	20%	3–5 named threats with concrete mitigations; not boilerplate
Component clarity	15%	C4 diagram readable; external dependencies named
SLO realism	20%	Targets anchored to user behavior; error budget the team will actually keep
Trade-off honesty	15%	Both sides named; trigger to revisit specified
Stakeholder map	10%	Each constraint has an owner; sign-off status is honest

The bar: a one- to two-page TCD an architect or engineering lead would accept as scoping input. The TCD ships alongside the PRD into Week 5.